

Questions to Ask Before TPLO Surgery

Bring the questions that fit your dog, home, and veterinary plan.

Surgery and follow-up

- What exactly is being repaired, and was meniscus damage found or expected?
- What follow-up visits and imaging are planned?
- How will I know whether healing is progressing as expected?

Home restrictions

- What are the rules for stairs, furniture, car loading, and bathroom trips?
- How much confinement is required, and what type of enclosure is appropriate?
- When may my dog have supervised freedom outside the enclosure?
- When may the cone come off, and what should I do if stitches are disturbed?

Activity

- What walking limits apply at each stage?
- When may swimming, hills, uneven ground, or rehabilitation exercises begin?
- Which activities require formal clearance rather than simply looking comfortable?

My dog's real life

- How should I handle severe storm or fireworks anxiety during recovery?
- What should I do if my dog's safest place requires stairs?
- How should other pets be managed?
- What behaviors or changes should trigger a same-day call or emergency visit?

Use this with the instructions from your own veterinary team. It is an owner-planning tool, not veterinary advice.